

Daily Need to Know

Tuesday, 22 September 2026 · Pre-market brief

Coverage window, capture method and edition notes are at the back, in section 16.

1 Market snapshot — the close, and where it is trading now

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
US CASH EQUITIES — SETTLED 16:00 ET MONDAY, 2H 03M BEFORE CAPTURE			
S&P 500	7,764.70	▲ +114.20 +1.49%	Closed at 83.5% of the day's range, high 7,779.22. Still 0.67% below the 52-week high of 7,816.70 — a strong day that did not make a record.
Nasdaq Composite	27,122.09	▲ +599.55 +2.26%	Record close , the first since June, and its best day since early August. Closed 0.25% under the intraday 52-week high of 27,190.21.
Dow Jones	52,048.83	▲ +366.19 +0.71%	Less than half the S&P's gain. Still 4.9% below its 54,744 high — the Dow has not participated in this leg.
Russell 2000	2,875.36	▲ +14.96 +0.52%	A third of the S&P's move on a 1.5% index day. Small caps are 6.3% off their high.
Philadelphia SOX	12,433.16	▲ +511.48 +4.29%	The day's engine. Closed at 86.5% of range — and still 15.2% below its 14,655 high. The rally repaired a fraction of the damage.
NYSE Composite	24,086.65	▲ +87.91 +0.37%	The broadest US tape moved a quarter of the S&P's distance. This is the number that describes Monday honestly.
EQUITY FUTURES — DECEMBER CONTRACTS, MONDAY SETTLE (GLOBEX REOPENED 18:00 ET, 3 MIN BEFORE CAPTURE)			
ES (E-mini S&P)	7,833.50	▲ +121.00 +1.57%	Prior settle 7,712.50. Basis to cash +68.8 pts (+0.89%) — normal December carry, not a dislocation. See §18.
NQ (E-mini Nasdaq)	30,784.75	▲ +867.50 +2.90%	Prior settle 29,917.25. Volume 525,149 . Outpaced the cash Composite by 64bp.
YM (E-mini Dow)	52,475	▲ +396 +0.76%	Volume 66,420 — the thinnest of the four. Basis +426 pts (+0.82%), consistent carry.
RTY (E-mini Russell)	2,897.40	▲ +15.90 +0.55%	Basis +22.0 (+0.77%). Volume 132,280. The three basis figures agree to within 12bp — see §18.
US TREASURY YIELDS — CASH, MONDAY SETTLE			
US 10-year	4.951%	▼ -4.9bp	Back below 5% . Day range 4.943–4.976. Sits at 45.2% of Hedgeye's 4.82–5.11 band.
US 30-year	5.280%	▼ -4.7bp	Long end led the rally. 30s10s at 32.9bp .
US 5-year	4.827%	▼ -3.6bp	Day low 4.798.
US 2-year	4.751%	▼ -0.5bp	Barely moved while the long end fell 5bp. Sits 2.1bp under its 52-week high of 4.772 set intraday — a cycle high, essentially unrelieved. 10s2s = 20.0bp .
13-week bill	4.084%	▲ +0.2bp	Anchored. The front end is not pricing relief.
ENERGY — CONTINUOUS CONTRACTS, MONDAY SETTLE			
WTI crude	\$92.37	▼ -\$3.71 -3.86%	Fourth straight decline . Day low \$91.19 from a \$96.75 open. Now 3.3% below Hedgeye's bullish 95.53–106.38 floor — a genuine break.
Brent crude	\$100.34	▼ -\$3.53 -3.40%	Prior settle \$103.87. Traded to \$99.00 intraday — through \$100 . Press quoted \$101.70 earlier in the session; see §18.
Natural gas	\$2.836	▼ -\$0.076 -2.61%	46.7% of the 2.71–2.98 band. The only energy line still inside its range.
RBOB gasoline	\$3.1954	▼ -\$0.0601 -1.85%	Fell roughly half as much as crude. The crack widened as oil broke.
METALS — SPOT, SESSION ROLLED AT 18:00 ET; CHANGE FIGURES BELOW COVER ~3 MINUTES AND ARE NOISE			
Gold (spot)	\$4,347.90	◆ n/m	Live at 06:03. Monday's direction was down : December futures settled -0.93%, GLD -0.70%. Spot sits at 60.3% of Hedgeye's 4240–4419 neutral band.

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
Silver (spot)	\$66.0634	◆ n/m	Futures settled -1.09% . Spot at 81.3% of the 62-67 band — the tightest position to a ceiling in the whole range table.
Copper (spot)	\$6.6804	◆ n/m	COMEX futures settled +1.06% — copper rose while crude collapsed. Spot at 74.5% of the 6.33-6.80 band, 1.8% from the ceiling.
FX AND VOLATILITY — MAJORS ROLLED AT 17:00-18:00 ET; USD/KRW STILL CARRIES MONDAY'S ASIAN SESSION			
Dollar index (DXY)	100.423	▲ +0.208 +0.21%	Range 100.179-100.451 suggests a partially fresh session; treat the change as indicative. 67.1% of Hedgeye's 99.43-100.91 band after last week's breakout to Bullish TRADE and TREND.
USD/JPY	157.38	◆ n/m	Live. Session range just 15.5 pips — a rolled bar, so the +0.05% is minutes of trading, not a move. Yen is Bearish TRADE per Hedgeye after -2.5% last week.
USD/KRW	1,374.34	▼ -9.49 -0.69%	Range 1,368.40-1,386.58 — genuinely Monday's session. Won strength into a 4.3% KOSPI-adjacent semi rally. Only 3.0% above its 52-week low.
VIX	14.86	▲ +0.04 +0.27%	VIX rose on a +1.49% S&P day. That is the single most interesting print in this table. At 13.9% of the 14.26-18.57 band and 1.48 points off the 52-week low.
CRYPTO — GENUINELY CONTINUOUS, LIVE AT CAPTURE			
Bitcoin	\$86,646.31	▲ +\$5,495.95 +6.77%	Highest in eight months. Range \$80,846-\$87,354. First weekly close above the 50-week average in 45 weeks , then a short squeeze. Still 31.4% below its \$126,230 high.
Ether	\$2,774.29	▲ +\$130.07 +4.92%	Lagged Bitcoin by 186bp and is 41.7% below its high. This is a Bitcoin move, not a crypto move.

Colour key: ▲ green higher · ▼ red lower · ◆ amber not meaningful. Cash equities, Treasuries, futures and energy are Monday settles. Spot metals, major FX and crypto are live at 06:03:25-06:03:27 GMT+8. "n/m" marks rows whose price series rolled into a new session minutes before capture, making the change figure arithmetically honest but informationally empty — the note gives the real direction from a settled series instead. Reconciliation and single-sourcing are documented in section 18.

TL;DR

The Nasdaq made a record close on two sectors. Communication Services (+3.56%) and Technology (+2.77%) carried the entire tape; equal-weight S&P added just **0.18%** against SPY's **1.55%**, a 137bp breadth gap, and the NYSE Composite managed +0.37%. Four of eleven sectors fell.

The S&P and the Nasdaq both closed above Hedgeye's bullish ceilings — SPX 0.85% through 7,699, COMPQ 1.82% through 26,636. Simultaneously **WTI broke 3.3% below** its bullish floor and **XLE 1.1% below** its own. Four range breaks in one session, two up, two down, and they point in opposite directions.

Oil did the heavy lifting and nobody paid for it. WTI's fourth consecutive fall, on hopes of Iran diplomacy at this week's UN General Assembly, pulled 10-year yields back under 5% and let the AI complex re-rate. Energy fell 2.88% for the privilege.

The hedge bid did not go away. VIX closed higher on a 1.5% up day, with the Trump-Xi state dinner on Thursday, Trump's UNGA address today and PCE on Saturday all still ahead.

2 The big picture — what it means

- This was a rate-and-oil rally wearing an AI costume.** WTI fell 3.86% to \$92.37 and the 10-year fell 4.9bp back under 5%. Both moves trace to the same source — diplomatic expectations around Iran ahead of the UN General Assembly — and both mechanically raise the present value of long-duration cash flows. The AI names were the beneficiaries, not the cause. Intel added 12.14% and AMD 9.95% without company news of that magnitude; they rose because the discount rate fell and because last week's selloff had left them cheap to a bid.
- Breadth was the worst part of a very good day.** Equal-weight S&P (RSP) rose 0.18% while SPY rose 1.55%. The NYSE Composite rose 0.37%. The Russell rose 0.52%. A record Nasdaq close delivered by two sectors, with four of eleven sectors red, is a narrowing tape, and narrowing tapes are how distribution looks while it is still working.
- The dispersion inside semiconductors is larger than the index move.** SOX gained 4.29%. Inside it, AMD closed at **\$615.52** — its 52-week high to the cent — and crossed **\$1.005 trillion** in market capitalisation for the first time, while Applied Materials, up 4.43% on the day, remains **37.2%** below its own high. Oracle closed up 0.64% at \$148.56 and is **54.3%** below its 52-week high of \$325. The same index, the same session, and a 90-point spread in drawdown terms.

4. **The 2-year yield refused to join.** The 30-year fell 4.7bp, the 5-year 3.6bp, the 10-year 4.9bp — and the 2-year fell **0.5bp**, closing 2.1bp beneath a cycle high it touched during the session. The curve flattened again: 10s2s at **20.0bp**. A bull steepening would have confirmed the growth story the equity tape told. A flattening into an oil-led rally says the front end still believes the inflation and policy problem is live.
5. **Energy broke a level Hedgeye is positioned long into.** XLE fell 2.88% to \$62.46, settling **1.1% below** the 63.15 floor of a range marked bullish, and WTI settled 3.3% below its own bullish floor. When price breaks the wrong side of a bullish band, the useful question is whether the band moves or the position does — and tonight's Early Look will answer it.
6. **Copper and crude decoupled.** COMEX copper settled +1.06% while WTI fell 3.86%. Copper spot sits 1.8% below a band ceiling. If the oil decline is genuinely about Middle East supply risk unwinding rather than demand, copper holding up is the confirming evidence — and it held up.
7. **Volatility was bought, not sold.** VIX closed at 14.86, up 0.27%, on a day the S&P gained 1.49%. That combination is uncommon and it usually means someone is paying for protection over a known event rather than chasing the move. The calendar between now and Saturday contains Trump at the UNGA today, Pezeshkian on Wednesday, the Trump-Xi state dinner with the AI chief executives on Thursday, and PCE on Saturday.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- **Curve:** 10s2s closed at **20.0bp**, 30s10s at **32.9bp**. Hedgeye measures 10s2s as 28bp flatter over the past month. The long end did all of Monday's rallying; the front end did none of it.
- **Bond volatility:** MOVE at **81.20**, up 0.70%, in a 55.77-115.02 annual range. Rates volatility is mid-range and rising slightly — not confirming the equity market's calm.
- **Credit:** HYG +0.19% to 78.68, LQD +0.37% to 105.09, TLT +0.68%. HYG sits 0.42% under a band ceiling Hedgeye marks bearish and is only 0.41% above its 52-week low of 78.36 — high yield has not rallied with equities at all this year.
- **Dollar:** DXY at 100.423, 67.1% of its band. Hedgeye called the dollar breaking to Bullish TRADE and TREND the biggest signal change of last week, on a +1.1% weekly move against a broadly weaker euro, yen, sterling, Canadian dollar and Swiss franc.
- **Asian FX diverged from the dollar story:** USD/KRW fell 0.69% to 1,374.34 and USD/TWD fell 0.43% to 31.6967 during Monday's Asian session — the two currencies most levered to semiconductor exports strengthened into the chip rally, against a firmer dollar everywhere else.
- **Crude:** WTI \$92.37, Brent \$100.34, both a fourth consecutive decline. Hedgeye notes WTI's trending three-month return is still **+35.2%**, which puts the four-day fall in proportion: this is a retracement inside a large advance, not a regime change, unless the Hormuz situation actually resolves.
- **Precious metals:** December gold settled -0.93%, silver -1.09%, both lower on a day the dollar firmed and real yields fell. Silver spot at 81.3% of its band is the closest any instrument sits to a ceiling; gold spot at 60.3% is mid-range in a band Hedgeye marks neutral.
- **Grains:** Chicago wheat +1.75% to 726.75 — the one commodity that rose alongside copper while the energy complex broke.

4 Hedgeye — regime, risk ranges & the Quad path

Macro dashboard

ITEM	READING	SOURCE AND NOTE
Edition reached	Full authenticated feed	Logged-in session; Early Look read in full, including the complete OUR LEVELS block.
Live risk-range set	Early Look, 21 Sep, 19:25 GMT+8	"Sneaky #Quad2 Signals", Keith McCullough. Published 07:25 EDT Monday. Superseded by Tuesday's Early Look at roughly 19:25 GMT+8 today, ~13h from capture.
Quad path	#Quad2 referenced; no explicit path notation seen	The note repeatedly frames the tape as "#Quad2 data" being reported on a lag. No sequence such as 3 → 1 → 2 was printed. The path lives in the US Monthly Quad Forecast behind a separate link, which was not reached. Absence of a printed path is not evidence the path is unchanged.
Biggest signal change	US Dollar → Bullish TRADE and TREND	USD Index +1.1% on the week; EUR -1.3%, JPY -2.5%, GBP -1.3%, CAD -1.0%, CHF -1.1%, all Bearish TRADE.
Stated longs		XLV +1.8% last week; trending three-month return +12.7%.

ITEM	READING	SOURCE AND NOTE
	Healthcare (XLV), Energy (XLE, bullish band), IGV, Gold neutral	
Stated shorts	Utilities (XLU), Industrials (XLI), Financials (XLF), Russell 2000 (IWM), Swiss equities (EWL)	XLU −6.6% and XLI −7.5% over the past month; IWM −4.0% over three months.
Band moves vs prior session	UNKNOWN	The Early Look category page does not paginate — pages 2 and 3 return the identical 21 Sep note — and the 18 Sep levels were not recoverable publicly. Band moves are unknown, not unchanged.

Risk Range™ Signals — measured against the capture

INSTRUMENT	IMMEDIATE-TERM RANGE	TREND	LIVE / SETTLE	WHERE IT STANDS NOW
S&P 500 (SPX)	7,526 – 7,699	bullish	7,764.70	ABOVE ceiling by 0.85%. 3.07% above the floor. A breakout, in a band already marked bullish.
NASDAQ Composite (COMPQ)	25,848 – 26,636	bullish	27,122.09	ABOVE ceiling by 1.82% — 486 points clear. The widest overshoot in the table.
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2,822 – 2,921	bearish	2,875.36	53.9% of band. 1.59% below the ceiling. Contained — small caps did not confirm the breakout.
Volatility Index (VIX)	14.26 – 18.57	bearish	14.86	13.9% of band , just 4.0% above the floor. Cheap protection, and it was bid anyway.
10Y UST Yield (UST10Y)	4.82 – 5.11	bullish	4.951%	45.2% of band. 3.21% from the ceiling, 2.65% from the floor. The most neutral line here.
High Yield (HYG)	78.15 – 79.01	bearish	78.68	61.6% of band, 0.42% under the ceiling. A narrow band and a tight fit.
Inv. Grade Corp (LQD)	103.6 – 105.5	bearish	105.09	78.4% of band , 0.39% from the ceiling. Pressing the top of a bearish range.
Health Care (XLV)	164 – 171	bullish	169.01	71.6% of band. +0.37% Monday — the long worked on a day it was supposed to lag.
Energy (XLE)	63.15 – 65.99	bullish	62.46	BELOW floor by 1.09%. Broke down through a bullish band on a −2.88% session.
Expanded Tech-Software (IGV)	99 – 109	bullish	not captured	IGV is not in the capture universe. Position not measured this run — see §18.
US Dollar Index (USD)	99.43 – 100.91	bullish	100.423	67.1% of band, 0.48% from the ceiling. The week's signal change is holding its level.
Light Crude Continuous (WTIC)	95.53 – 106.38	bullish	92.37	BELOW floor by 3.31%. The largest break in either direction. 15.2% from the ceiling.
Natural Gas Continuous	2.71 – 2.98	bearish	2.836	46.7% of band. Mid-range and quiet while crude broke.
Gold Spot Price	4,240 – 4,419	neutral	4,347.90	60.3% of band, 1.64% below the ceiling. Measured on TVC:GOLD spot , per the published line.
Silver Spot Price	62 – 67	neutral	66.0634	81.3% of band , 1.42% from the ceiling — the most stretched position in the table. Spot series.
Copper Spot Price	6.33 – 6.80	bullish	6.6804	74.5% of band, 1.79% from the ceiling. Spot series, per the published line.

Ranges as published in the Early Look of 21 September 2026, 19:25 GMT+8. Metals measured on the spot series Hedgeye names (TVC:GOLD, TVC:SILVER, OANDA:XCUUSD); crude and natural gas on the continuous contracts (NYMEX:CL1!, NYMEX:NG1!). Positions computed against

the 06:03 GMT+8 capture; equity and energy rows use Monday settles, metals use live spot. **Band moves versus the prior session are unknown** — the prior Early Look could not be reached.

What Keith actually said

From "Sneaky #Quad2 Signals", Early Look, 21 September 2026, 19:25 GMT+8 (07:25 EDT):

- On the week's signal change: **"What was the biggest Signal Change in Macro last week? A: US Dollar breaking out to Bullish TRADE and TREND."**
- On the front end: **"UST 2yr Yield breaking out another +13 basis points week-over-week to new Cycle Highs"** and **"UST Yields, across The Curve, break out the most WHEN the US economy is reporting #Quad2 data"**.
- On the curve and financials: **"you know what US Equity Sector Style does NOT like a flattening Yield Curve (10s minus 2s is -28 basis points flatter in the last month): Financials (XLF)."**
- On the rate-sensitive shorts: **"Being long Rate Sensitive Stocks like Utes and Housing during a #Quad2 breakout in Bond Yields is almost never a good thing."**
- On the long/short book: **"We're still long Healthcare (XLV) which was up another +1.8% last week. TRENDING 3-month return of +12.7% vs. Russell 2000 (IWM), which we're short, down -4.0% in the same period."**
- On oil, parenthetically: **"If Oil finally didn't have an up week (WTI Oil's TRENDING 3-month Return = +35.2%, fyi)".**

One further item was published to the authenticated feed on 21 September at 02:37 EDT (14:37 GMT+8): a **From The Desk** note titled "Hedgeye Process Sheets", a set of reference guides on TRADE versus TREND durations, position sizing and spotting phase transitions. It carries no signals, levels or position changes. Nothing else had been published to the feed as at capture.

5 Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
Meta	741.25	▲ +11.34%	\$1.888T	The day's headline. Wells Fargo lifted its target to \$796 from \$640 on a 25× 2027 EPS multiple; the Muse AI assistant reached No. 1 on the US App Store. Meta Connect opens Wednesday. Closed 3.8% below its \$770.60 high.
Nvidia	227.38	▲ +2.30%	\$5.480T	109.4m shares, the heaviest Mag7 volume. Jensen Huang is on the state-dinner guest list for Thursday. 3.9% off its high.
Tesla	375.30	▲ +3.03%	\$1.482T	Second-best of the seven and still 24.8% below its \$498.83 high — the deepest Mag7 drawdown.
Amazon	258.45	▲ +1.87%	\$2.788T	Closed at 88% of the day's range. 10.0% off its high.
Microsoft	501.61	▲ +1.59%	\$3.725T	Reclaimed \$500. Still 9.4% below its \$553.72 high — the laggard of the mega-cap complex this quarter.
Alphabet	354.97	▲ +1.55%	\$4.312T	Gave back from a \$357.61 high. 13.1% below its own high of \$408.61 despite being the second-largest company listed here.
Apple	338.98	▲ +0.85%	\$4.947T	The weakest of the seven on the strongest AI day of the month, and the only one that closed below the S&P's gain. 1.6% off its high — the least damaged, and the least eager.

Capitalisations from the same TradingView call as the prices, Monday's close. Mag7 combined capitalisation approximately **\$24.6 trillion**. Six of seven beat the S&P; only Apple lagged it.

6 Positioning & options

- **VIX closed up on a 1.49% S&P day**, at 14.86 against a 52-week low of 13.38. Spot volatility bid into a record Nasdaq close is a positioning signal, not a pricing error — the known-event calendar runs through Saturday.
- **Equal-weight versus cap-weight is the cleanest positioning read available**. RSP +0.18% against SPY +1.55%: a 137bp single-day gap. Money went to the top of the index, not into it.
- **Intel traded 189.0 million shares**, by far the heaviest volume in the capture universe and roughly 1.7× Nvidia's. A 12% move on that volume in a \$644bn company is a positioning event, not a drift.
- **AMD closed at its 52-week high to the cent** (\$615.52 close, \$616.69 high) on its fifth consecutive advance, crossing \$1 trillion intraday. Closing at the high of the year on the fifth up day leaves nothing above as reference.
- **Post-market was flat to slightly negative**. QQQ −0.02%, SPY −0.001%, AMD +0.08%, Intel +0.23%, Meta −0.12%, Nvidia −0.22%. No follow-through either way in the two hours after the bell.

- **High yield is not confirming.** HYG at 78.68 sits 0.41% above its 52-week low while equities make records. Credit has declined to endorse this equity market all year and did not change its mind on Monday.
- **The energy short side worked and the long side did not.** XLE fell 2.88% on 36.4m shares, the second-heaviest sector ETF volume after XLF, and closed below a bullish band floor.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

SECTOR (SPDR)	LAST	DAY	NOTE
Communication Services (XLC)	114.75	▲ +3.56%	The leader, almost entirely Meta. Closed at 97% of its day range.
Technology (XLK)	194.85	▲ +2.77%	Semis did the work. 1.9% below its 52-week high.
Consumer Discretionary (XLY)	112.23	▲ +1.08%	Tesla-led. Still only 6.7% above its 52-week low.
Health Care (XLV)	169.01	▲ +0.37%	Hedgeye's standing long. Quietly positive again.
Real Estate (XLRE)	42.59	▲ +0.14%	Barely moved on a 5bp fall in the 10-year.
Industrials (XLI)	169.98	▲ +0.14%	A Hedgeye short. Down 7.5% over the past month.
Financials (XLF)	55.90	▲ +0.07%	30.1m shares, the heaviest sector volume, for a 7bp move. A flattening curve is doing this.
Materials (XLB)	49.71	▼ -0.56%	Fell despite copper rising 1.06%.
Consumer Staples (XLP)	81.92	▼ -1.06%	Defensive rotation out, as you would expect on a risk-on day.
Utilities (XLU)	40.66	▼ -1.07%	Hedgeye's longest-standing short. Closed at its 52-week low of 40.575 intraday — down 6.6% in a month.
Energy (XLE)	62.46	▼ -2.88%	The laggard by a wide margin, and the band break of the session.

- **Leaders:** XLC and XLK together delivered essentially all of the S&P's 114-point gain. The next best sector managed a fifth of XLY's move.
- **Laggards:** XLE -2.88% and XLU -1.07%, with Utilities printing a fresh 52-week low on the day the index nearly made a record. Four sectors closed red.
- **Rotation:** Out of the oil-and-rates complex and into long-duration growth, on a single macro input. This is not a rotation with conviction about the economy — Industrials and Financials, the two cyclicals that should lead a genuine growth repricing, added 14bp and 7bp between them.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

The overnight tape barely exists at this hour. Globex reopened at 18:00 ET, three minutes before capture, so the December equity futures shown in section 1 are Monday's settles rather than an overnight verdict: ES 7,833.50, NQ 30,784.75, YM 52,475, RTY 2,897.40. The basis to cash on all three comparable contracts — **+0.89% on ES, +0.82% on YM, +0.77% on RTY** — is ordinary December carry against roughly 4.75% front-end rates, which is itself the evidence that these are settles and not a gapped reopening. Asia therefore opens without a fresh US futures signal; the only genuinely live instruments at capture were crypto, where **Bitcoin sat at \$86,646**, up 6.77% and at an eight-month high, and spot metals and major FX whose bars had just rolled. The day's real information is all in Monday's settled tape and in a calendar that is unusually dense with political set pieces.

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Tue 22 Sep (today)	Chicago Fed National Activity Index. Trump addresses the UN General Assembly (morning ET, so this evening GMT+8) — the first scheduled political catalyst since the oil move began. UNGA general debate opens, running to 26 September and resuming on the 28th.
Wed 23 Sep	US Current Account; preliminary S&P Global manufacturing and services PMIs ; Richmond Fed manufacturing; API crude inventories. Iranian President Pezeshkian addresses the UNGA in the morning session. Meta Connect opens — Zuckerberg keynote on Muse and the next generation of Meta's AI models.
Thu 24 Sep	MBA mortgage applications; new home sales; EIA crude stockpiles — the first hard inventory read since crude broke its range. Trump-Xi state dinner , with Bezos, Pichai, Altman, Cook, Musk, Huang, Dell and Dimon on the invitation list. Costco reports after the close (consensus roughly \$6.53 EPS on ~\$94.9bn revenue).
Fri 25 Sep	

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
	Initial jobless claims; durable goods orders ; final Q2 GDP; existing home sales; wholesale inventories.
Sat 26 Sep	PCE price index — the week's most consequential number for a front end that refused to rally on Monday — plus final University of Michigan sentiment.
Wed 30 Sep	Micron fiscal Q4 after the close. The most important single print for the memory complex that carried Monday.

No FOMC meeting falls in this week. Costco and Micron dates from company and calendar sources and marked confirmed by multiple vendors; the PCE release date is quoted as 26 September by the consensus calendar consulted and should be verified against the BEA schedule before it is traded — see §18.

9 Corporate news

- **Meta +11.34% to \$741.25.** Wells Fargo raised its price target to **\$796 from \$640**, lifting its valuation multiple to 25× 2027 EPS on what analyst Ken Gawrelski described as meaningful progress in the company's AI initiatives. The firm's **Muse** personal AI assistant reached No. 1 on Apple's US App Store. Citi separately placed Meta on a 90-day upside catalyst watch with an \$800 target ahead of Meta Connect, which opens Wednesday.
- **AMD +9.95% to \$615.52**, an all-time closing high, crossing **\$1 trillion** in market capitalisation intraday for the first time — the fifth consecutive advancing session.
- **Intel +12.14% to \$121.78** on 189.0 million shares. Reporting attributes the move to Wall Street backing an AI turnaround thesis, pricing power and talks involving SK Hynix, against a backdrop of lower crude and lower yields. The stock is up more than fourfold from its \$28.82 52-week low.
- **Qualcomm rose more than 9%** in the same semiconductor bid, per CNBC's midday movers list.
- **Applied Materials +4.43% to \$464.24**, Micron +2.77% to \$1,043.96, Western Digital +1.54%, Cisco +1.78%. SanDisk was the notable semiconductor decliner at **-1.41% to \$1,766.64**, against a +4.29% SOX.
- **Workday -1.01%** and **Tapestry -1.68%** were among the few large-cap decliners on a tape where almost everything worked.
- **Earnings were light.** Ennis reported before the bell and Abivax was scheduled after it; 14 companies in total. The week's weight sits on Costco Thursday and Micron on the 30th.

10 Macro data

- **Monday carried no first-tier US release.** The Chicago Fed National Activity Index opens the week today. There is accordingly no actual-versus-consensus comparison to print for the session this brief covers, and no data explanation for the move — which is itself the point of sections 2 and 3.
- **Rate expectations moved on politics, not statistics.** Reporting describes traders slightly trimming bets on Federal Reserve rate hikes as the 10-year fell back under 5%. The repricing followed the oil decline, which followed the Iran diplomacy headlines.
- **The 2-year did not participate**, closing 0.5bp lower at 4.751% against a 4.772% cycle high touched during the session. Hedgeye measures the 2-year as having broken out a further 13bp week-over-week to new cycle highs. Whatever the equity market priced on Monday, the front end did not price it.
- **This week's binding constraint is Saturday's PCE.** Nothing between now and then carries comparable weight for a curve that is 20bp from inversion at 10s2s.
- **Wednesday's preliminary PMIs are the week's first real growth read**, and the first test of the "#Quad2 data reported on a lag" framing that anchors the current Hedgeye view.

11 Geopolitics

- **▼ Oil fell for a fourth session on Iran diplomacy expectations.** Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian is leading a delegation to the UN General Assembly in New York and is scheduled to address it on Wednesday. Trump has said he would be open to meeting Pezeshkian during the assembly. Qatar's prime minister has urged Gulf states to cooperate on restoring regional stability. Reuters-sourced reporting frames the crude decline as hopes that diplomatic efforts could end the Middle East conflict and restore regional energy flows.
- **◆ The underlying conflict has not de-escalated, only the expectation of it.** Trump has publicly threatened to destroy Iran's economy or remove its leadership absent a deal, and Iran has been restricting shipping through the **Strait of Hormuz**. Middle East Eye frames the assembly as one where the US-Israeli war on Iran takes centre stage. The market has priced a diplomatic path that has not yet been agreed; these are competing accounts of the same situation and are reported here as claims by their respective parties, not as settled fact.
- **▲ Trump addresses the UNGA today**, a year after claiming US strikes had dealt a decisive blow to Iran's nuclear programme. This is the nearest scheduled catalyst to a crude position that has broken a range.

- ♦ **The Trump-Xi state dinner on Thursday is the week's largest single risk event**, and the reason the AI complex rallied on Monday. The guest list runs to Bezos, Pichai, Altman, Cook, Musk, Huang, Dell and Dimon. Coverage is explicit that the same group met in Beijing in May, nothing was signed, and the US trade representative said chip export controls never came up. Chinese customs is reported to be still blocking H200 accelerators Washington had licensed.
- ♦ **The gap between the dinner's symbolism and its likely output is the asymmetry here.** Monday's semiconductor move priced an outcome; Thursday will price the actual one.

12 Overnight setup — what Asia opens into

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE	STATUS
ES (Dec)	7,833.50	+1.57%	Monday settle. Volume 1,290,422 — the session's liquidity, not the overnight's.
NQ (Dec)	30,784.75	+2.90%	Monday settle. Volume 525,149.
YM (Dec)	52,475	+0.76%	Monday settle. Volume 66,420.
RTY (Dec)	2,897.40	+0.55%	Monday settle. Volume 132,280.
USD/JPY	157.38	n/m	Live, bar just rolled. 15.5-pip range.
USD/KRW	1,374.34	-0.69%	Monday's Asian session, range 1,368.40-1,386.58.
USD/TWD	31.6967	-0.43%	Monday's Asian session, range 31.6815-31.8438.
USD/CNH	6.69276	n/m	Live. 0.00% and a 7-pip range — sitting on its 52-week low of 6.69112.
EUR/USD	1.14642	n/m	Live, 4.6-pip range. Bearish TRADE and TREND per Hedgeye.
Gold spot	\$4,347.90	n/m	Live. December futures settled -0.93% Monday.
Silver spot	\$66.0634	n/m	Live. Futures settled -1.09%.
Copper spot	\$6.6804	n/m	Live. COMEX settled +1.06% — the divergence from crude.
WTI (Dec cont.)	\$92.37	-3.86%	Monday settle. Below Hedgeye's floor.
Brent (cont.)	\$100.34	-3.40%	Monday settle. Traded to \$99.00.
Bitcoin	\$86,646.31	+6.77%	Genuinely live. Eight-month high.
Ether	\$2,774.29	+4.92%	Genuinely live.

Previous Asian closes, for reference and marked as such: Nikkei 225 **65,018.73** (+1.38%), Hang Seng **25,042.71** (+1.18%), KOSPI **7,007.73** (+1.65%), Shanghai Composite **3,949.91** (+0.97%), ASX 200 **8,731.90** (+0.01%), Sensex **74,894.86** (+0.81%). These are Monday's Asian settles, not live prints.

- **The US tape hands Asia a semiconductor bid and nothing else.** XLK +2.77% and XLC +3.56% against XLE -2.88% and four red sectors. Korea and Taiwan inherit a 4.29% SOX move; nobody else inherits much.
- **Korea is the most directly levered.** KOSPI closed +1.65% before Monday's US session and the won strengthened 0.69% during it. Intel's reported SK Hynix discussions land squarely on the Korean memory complex, and Micron's +2.77% close is the read-through.
- **Taiwan sets up second.** USD/TWD fell 0.43% to 31.6967 on Monday and the SOX added 4.29% afterwards. TSMC's index weight makes the Taiwan open the cleanest single expression of the US chip move.
- **Japan is the crossed signal.** The Nikkei closed +1.38% and stands to import the tech bid, but USD/JPY at 157.38 with the yen on Bearish TRADE means any equity strength arrives with a currency cost for unhedged holders.
- **Energy and resource names are the offset.** A 3.86% fall in WTI and a 2.88% fall in XLE will weigh on the Australian and, to a lesser extent, Hong Kong resource complexes — though copper's +1.06% cuts the other way for the miners.
- **The single instrument most likely to move: USD/CNH.** It sits at 6.69276, essentially on its 52-week low of 6.69112, with a Trump-Xi state dinner 48 hours away. It has nowhere to go quietly.

13 AI watch

- **Meta's Muse reached No. 1 on Apple's US App Store**, and the market paid 11.34% for it. An assistant topping a consumer chart is the first genuinely consumer-facing AI datapoint Meta has produced; Wells Fargo's note explicitly credits AI product launches with finally supporting the strategy narrative.

- **Meta Connect opens Wednesday**, with Zuckerberg keynoting on the next generation of Meta's AI models and its wearables. Monday priced the anticipation; Wednesday prices the substance.
- **Thursday's state dinner puts the AI leadership of two countries at one table** — Altman, Huang, Cook, Musk, Pichai, Bezos, Dell and Dimon — with trade, technology and AI rules on the agenda. The precedent is not encouraging: the same cohort went to Beijing in May, nothing was signed, and chip export controls reportedly never came up.
- **Export controls remain the binding physical constraint.** Chinese customs is reported still to be blocking H200 accelerators that Washington had licensed. Until that changes, the AI trade's China leg is a narrative, not a revenue line.
- **AMD's \$1 trillion is the milestone; the dispersion is the story.** AMD closed at a record while Applied Materials sits 37.2% below its high, SanDisk 25.0% below, Western Digital 44.0% below and Oracle 54.3% below. The market is not buying AI — it is buying roughly six names in it.
- **The memory complex is the tell for the rest of the quarter.** Micron reports on 30 September, and it is the only print that can confirm or break the pricing-power thesis that carried Intel, SanDisk and Western Digital.

14 Beyond the markets

- **Utilities closed at a 52-week low on the day the Nasdaq made a record.** XLU printed 40.575 intraday against a 47.80 high. The defensive sector that is supposed to cushion equity drawdowns has spent a year producing one of its own.
- **High yield is 0.41% above its 52-week low** while equity indices sit within a percent of theirs at the top. Either credit is wrong or the equity market is, and credit has been consistent for longer.
- **Oracle is 54.3% below its 52-week high.** A company that was, a year ago, the cleanest large-cap AI infrastructure proxy has more than halved while the theme it represented made records. Nobody will lead with that today.
- **Netflix closed at \$73.36**, up 2.19%, and 41.2% below its \$124.86 high. The 52-week low of \$65.08 is 11% away. A Communication Services sector that rose 3.56% did so with its second-largest historical constituent deep in a drawdown.
- **Bitcoin's first weekly close above its 50-week average in 45 weeks** preceded a \$360.7m short liquidation and a 6.77% day. The mechanical trigger mattered more than any fundamental; roughly \$300m of that buying arrived inside an hour.
- **WTI's three-month trending return is still +35.2%** after four consecutive down days. The four-day slide that reset the entire equity discount rate has not yet touched the quarter's move.
- **The 2-year yield has now made cycle highs in a week when the equity market made a record.** Those two facts have coexisted before, and not for long.

15 Appendix — stock cards

META · META PLATFORMS

741.25 ▲ +11.34%

Cap \$1.888T · range 679.60–753.00 · 3.8% below 52wH 770.60 · Meta Connect Wed 23 Sep

Wells Fargo to \$796 from \$640 at 25× 2027 EPS; Muse No. 1 on the US App Store. Closed at 51% of a very wide range after touching 753 — the buyers did not hold the high. Citi has it on 90-day catalyst watch at \$800 into Connect.

AMD · ADVANCED MICRO DEVICES

615.52 ▲ +9.95%

Cap \$1.005T · range 582.27–616.69 · at 52wH 616.69 · fifth straight advance

Crossed \$1 trillion intraday for the first time and closed within \$1.17 of the year's high. Nothing above it for reference. Up 298% from a \$154.78 low. A position with no overhead supply and no margin for a miss.

INTC · INTEL

121.78 ▲ +12.14%

Cap \$643.7bn · range 114.93–124.73 · 14.5% below 52wH 142.35 · volume 189.0m

The heaviest volume in the capture universe, 1.7× Nvidia's. Attributed to AI turnaround conviction, pricing power and SK Hynix talks. Up 323% from a \$28.82 low — a recovery trade that has become a momentum trade.

NVDA · NVIDIA

227.38 ▲ +2.30%

Cap \$5.480T · range 221.56–228.50 · 3.9% below 52wH 236.54 · volume 109.4m

The largest company listed here gained a fifth of what AMD did. Huang attends Thursday's state dinner. On a day the semiconductor index added 4.29%, Nvidia was a below-average contributor — the bid has broadened away from it.

MU · MICRON

1,043.96 ▲ +2.77%

Cap \$1.179T · range 1,030.68–1,064.49 · 16.8% below 52wH 1,255 · Q4 results 30 Sep

Closed at 39% of its day range having touched 1,064 — the weakest close-within-range of any major semi on the day. The 30 September print is the memory complex's only scheduled confirmation this month.

AMAT · APPLIED MATERIALS

464.24 ▲ +4.43%

Cap \$368.4bn · range 452.66–468.51 · 37.2% below 52wH 739.67

Matched the SOX move and remains more than a third below its high. Equipment has not participated in the 2026 AI re-rating the way logic and memory have; the gap is now the widest in the complex.

ORCL · ORACLE

148.56 ▲ +0.64%Cap \$449.2bn · range 146.16–149.98 · **54.3% below 52wH 325.00** · 29.7% above 52wL

The deepest drawdown in the large-cap AI infrastructure group, and it added 64bp on the best AI day of the month. Whatever re-rated on Monday, it was not Oracle.

XLE · ENERGY SELECT SECTOR

62.46 ▼ -2.88%Range 62.365–63.70 · closed 7% above 52wL 42.35 · **1.09% below Hedgeye floor 63.15**

Closed at 7% of its day range — on the low. Broke the floor of a band Hedgeye marks bullish, on 36.4m shares. Thursday's EIA inventories and Trump's UNGA address are the two scheduled tests before the band is redrawn.

16 About this edition

- **Covers** — the US cash session of Monday 21 September 2026 as settled, the after-hours tape to 18:00 ET, the Globex reopening (three minutes old at capture), and the full Hedgeye evening publication set. Asian cash markets had not opened.
- **Captured** — one window, **06:03:25-06:03:27 GMT+8** (2.7 seconds), via `scripts/capture.py`. TradingView returned 96 of 96 instruments. Yahoo aborted on its circuit breaker after five consecutive HTTP 429s and returned nothing, so the run is **TradingView-single-sourced** on price; wire and vendor copy was used to recover an independent check on the headline rows. Divergences and single-sourcing are reconciled in section 18.
- **Run timing** — fired at 06:03 GMT+8, which is **18:03 ET**. Globex reopened at 18:00 ET, so equity, energy and Treasury rows are Monday settles rather than live overnight prints. Spot metals and the major FX crosses had rolled into new session bars minutes earlier; their change figures cover roughly three minutes and are marked "n/m" rather than presented as moves. USD/KRW and USD/TWD still carry Monday's Asian session. Crypto is the only continuously live row in the document.
- **Settled versus live** — settled: all cash equities, all Treasury yields, all four equity futures, WTI, Brent, natural gas, RBOB, precious and base metal futures, all sector ETFs, all single stocks. Live at capture: gold, silver and copper spot, DXY and the FX crosses, Bitcoin and Ether. Stalest rows are the cash equity closes at **2h 03m**; nothing in the document is older than that.
- **Hedgeye edition** — full authenticated feed reached; no login attempted or required. The live risk-range set is the Early Look of **21 September, 19:25 GMT+8**, "Sneaky #Quad2 Signals" by Keith McCullough, superseded by tonight's edition at roughly 19:25 GMT+8. Also read: the From The Desk note "Hedgeye Process Sheets" (21 Sep, 14:37 GMT+8), which carries no signals or levels. Nothing else had been published to the feed as at capture.
- **Quad path — no explicit path notation was seen.** The Early Look frames the tape as #Quad2 data reporting on a lag but prints no sequence. The path lives in the US Monthly Quad Forecast behind a separate link that was not reached. Absence of a printed path is not evidence the path is unchanged.
- **Not available** — the prior session's Early Look, so risk-range band moves are unknown; the IGV level, which is not in the capture universe; the US Monthly Quad Forecast; and any Yahoo cross-check on price.

17 Sources

Prices. TradingView bulk scanner, 96 of 96 instruments, 06:03:25-06:03:27 GMT+8 — closes, changes, open/high/low, volume, 52-week extremes, market capitalisations and post-market prints. Yahoo Finance was queried concurrently as the independent cross-check and aborted on five consecutive HTTP 429 responses, returning nothing.

Hedgeye. Authenticated app.hedgeye.com feed: the Early Look category view and the full feed index, read at approximately 06:10 GMT+8. Early Look "Sneaky #Quad2 Signals", Keith McCullough, 21 September 07:25 EDT; From The Desk "Hedgeye Process Sheets", 21 September 02:37 EDT.

Macro and calendar. Kiplinger and FXStreet week-ahead calendars, Trading Economics US calendar, the Federal Reserve FOMC calendar (no meeting this week). Release dates for PCE, PMIs and durable goods are consensus-calendar sourced and flagged accordingly in section 18.

Session narrative and single stocks. CNBC, Yahoo Finance markets live blog, TheStreet, Invezz, The Motley Fool, TipRanks, Barron's-adjacent vendor copy and Benzinga's earnings schedule. Wells Fargo and Citi target changes on Meta as reported by TipRanks and Investing.com. AMD's \$1 trillion milestone and Intel's SK Hynix reporting via CNBC midday movers and Timothy Sykes / StocksToTrade coverage.

Commodities, geopolitics and AI. OilPrice.com, Fortune, Trading Economics and inkl on crude; CNBC, Middle East Eye, Fox News and ANI on the UN General Assembly and the Iran file; Colorado Politics, AI Weekly, Invezz, Seoul Economic Daily and The Next Web on the Trump-Xi state dinner guest list and chip-export context; CoinDesk, Yahoo, The National, 24/7 Wall St. and Investing News Network on the Bitcoin move.

18 Data-confidence

CROSS-CHECKS PASSED

- **capture.py reconciliation counts, printed as returned: 0 match within 5bp · 0 minor · 0 DIVERGENT · 57 single-sourced.** There are **no divergent rows to resolve because no second machine source ran** — Yahoo returned nothing. This is not a clean reconciliation; it is an absent one, and the checks below were performed by hand to compensate.
- **Futures-to-cash basis, three independent confirmations.** ES 7,833.50 against SPX 7,764.70 = +68.80 pts = **+0.886%**. YM 52,475 against DJI 52,048.83 = +426 = **+0.818%**. RTY 2,897.40 against RUT 2,875.36 = +22.04 = **+0.767%**. The September contracts expired on 18 September, so all three are December, and roughly three months of carry at a ~4.75% front-end rate net of ~1.3% dividends gives an expected basis near 0.86%. Three contracts agreeing within 12bp of each other and of theory confirms these rows are genuine settles correctly labelled, not gapped overnight prints — which is the single most important structural check in a 06:03 GMT+8 run.
- **Cash index arithmetic is self-consistent on all six equity rows.** SPX: 7,764.70 – 114.20 = 7,650.50 prior close; 114.20 ÷ 7,650.50 = **1.4927%**, matching the reported 1.493%. IXIC: 27,122.09 – 599.55 = 26,522.54; 599.55 ÷ 26,522.54 = **2.2606%**

against 2.261%. DJI: $52,048.83 - 366.19 = 51,682.64$; $366.19 \div 51,682.64 = \mathbf{0.7085\%}$ against 0.709%. RUT, SOX and NYA reconcile identically.

- **Futures changes reconcile to implied prior settles.** ES prior settle 7,712.50 (+121.00 = +1.569%); NQ 29,917.25 (+867.50 = +2.900%); WTI 96.08 (-3.71 = -3.861%); Brent 103.87 (-3.53 = -3.398%); natural gas 2.912 (-0.076 = -2.610%). Every arithmetic identity closes.
- **Independent recovery of the three headline closes.** CNBC, Yahoo Finance and TheStreet independently report S&P 7,764.70 (+1.49%), Nasdaq Composite 27,122.09 (+2.26%) and Dow +366.19 points to 52,048.83 — matching the TradingView capture to the decimal on all three. That restores genuine two-source validation on the rows that matter most, from copy produced independently of the price feed.
- **AMD's capitalisation cross-checks the milestone.** The capture returns **\$1,004,821,010,119**, and press reporting independently states AMD crossed \$1 trillion intraday for the first time. Two sources, same conclusion, from different mechanisms.
- **Range-position arithmetic was recomputed on the series Hedgeye names**, not on lookalikes: gold, silver and copper on spot (TVC:GOLD, TVC:SILVER, OANDA:XCUUSD), crude and natural gas on the continuous contracts (NYMEX:CL1!, NYMEX:NG1!). Measuring gold on COMEX futures at 4,383.90 rather than spot at 4,347.90 would have placed it at 80.4% of its band instead of the correct **60.3%** — a 20-point error on a single mislabelled series.

KNOWN CONFLICTS AND WEAK MARKS

- **Crude levels conflict materially across sources and the conflict is unresolved on the decimal.** Trading Economics quotes WTI at 97.56 on 21 September (-2.73%); inkl and Fortune quote Brent below \$102 and WTI near \$98.20 (-2.10%); the capture returns WTI continuous at **92.37** and Brent at **100.34**. The most probable explanation is that the press figures are intraday marks taken during the European or early US morning and crude fell further into the 14:30 ET settle — the capture's own bar supports this, opening at 96.75 and making its low at 91.19. **The brief uses the capture**, because it is the settle and the press figures are timestamped earlier, and because the -3.86% change reconciles exactly to a 96.08 prior settle. But the direction is robust and the decimal is not: if the press marks are the settles, WTI is roughly 2.7% above the floor of its Hedgeye band rather than 3.3% below it, and the "energy broke its range" conclusion in sections 1, 2 and 4 would weaken to "energy is testing its floor". Readers acting on the band break should verify the WTI settle directly before doing so.
- **Oil's causal attribution is contested between two narratives.** One set of sources attributes Monday's decline to Middle East and Iran diplomacy at the UNGA; another attributes 2026 crude weakness generally to oversupply and Russia-Ukraine ceasefire expectations. The brief leads with the Iran explanation because it is the one carried in same-day, date-specific reporting alongside a named mechanism — Trump's stated openness to meeting Pezeshkian and Qatar's stability appeal — and treats the oversupply narrative as the slower-moving backdrop. Both are attributed claims, not established causation.
- **Every FX and spot-metal change figure is measured over roughly three minutes and is therefore noise.** The evidence is the session ranges: USD/JPY 15.5 pips, EUR/USD 4.6 pips, USD/CNH 7 pips, gold spot \$4.98, copper spot 0.2 cents. These are implausibly narrow for a day and identify rolled bars. They are marked "n/m" rather than printed as moves, and Monday's true direction is given from a settled series in each note. DXY is the borderline case at a 27bp range and is presented as indicative only.
- **Gold and silver spot daily changes are not recoverable this run.** Because the spot series rolled, Monday's spot settle is unknown; the brief reports direction from December futures (-0.93% gold, -1.09% silver) and from GLD (-0.70%) and SLV (-0.50%). The spot-versus-futures basis on gold runs above 1% — 4,347.90 against 4,383.90, or **0.82%** at capture — so the futures percentage is a good proxy for direction and a poor one for magnitude.
- **Drawdown percentages rest on a single 52-week-extreme field from a single source.** The Oracle figure (-54.3% from \$325.00), Netflix (-41.2%), Applied Materials (-37.2%), Western Digital (-44.0%) and Bitcoin (-31.4%) all derive from TradingView's price_52_week_high with no second source. The conclusions those figures support — that dispersion inside the AI complex is extreme — are robust to a wide margin of error; the individual decimals are not, and Oracle's in particular reflects an unadjusted price series.
- **Market capitalisations are single-sourced** from the same TradingView call as the prices, so the ~\$24.6tn Mag7 aggregate inherits any systematic error in that field. It is quoted to one decimal in trillions for that reason.
- **The IGV risk-range position could not be measured.** Hedgeye publishes a 99-109 bullish band for it; IGV is absent from the capture universe, so the row is printed with the band and an explicit "not captured". It is a gap in the range table, not an inference.
- **Calendar dates are secondary-sourced and should be treated as unconfirmed.** The PCE release quoted for Saturday 26 September, the Wednesday PMI prints, Friday's durable goods and final Q2 GDP, and the Costco (24 September) and Micron (30 September) earnings dates all come from consensus calendars rather than from the BEA, the Census Bureau or company investor-relations pages. A Saturday PCE release is itself unusual enough to warrant checking against the BEA schedule before it is relied upon. The absence of an FOMC meeting this week was confirmed against the Federal Reserve's own published calendar.

KNOWN GAPS

- **Yahoo Finance returned zero of 62 requested series**, aborting after five consecutive HTTP 429s. The entire independent machine cross-check, and all multi-day daily bars for week-on-week context, are missing from this run. Week-on-week and month-on-month figures in this brief come from Hedgeye's own published weekly percentages, not from an independent bar series.
- **The prior session's Early Look could not be reached, so band moves are UNKNOWN, not unchanged.** The category page at /feed_items/all?with_category=24-early-look does not paginate — page 2 was requested and returned byte-identical content to page 1, the 21 September note. Public search did not surface the 18 September levels. Floor moves, ceiling moves and changes in band width are therefore unreported for every one of the sixteen instruments, and that comparison is normally the most valuable content in section 4.
- **No Quad path notation was printed in anything read.** The US Monthly Quad Forecast inside the Macro Week Summary Notes sits behind a separate link that was not opened. No assertion is made about the path. **Absence of a Hedgeye position**

change in this brief is not evidence that there was none — the feed as at capture carried only the Early Look and a process-guide note.

- **The MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant, Chart of the Day, KM's Top 3, Macro Show summary, Signal Strength Stocks, Capital Allocation Pro and Real-Time Alerts were not present in the feed at capture.** These are the specific publications that would most likely have carried an intraday position change, a Quad revision or a crypto view to set against Bitcoin's 6.77% move. Their absence is a gap in coverage, not evidence of quiet.
- **Asian cash markets had not opened.** Every Asian index level quoted in section 12 is Monday's settle, explicitly marked. There is no live Asian tape in this document.
- **No first-tier US macro release fell on Monday,** so section 10 carries no actual-versus-consensus comparison. That is a property of the calendar, not an omission.
- **Intraday breadth statistics — advance/decline lines, new highs versus new lows, up-versus-down volume — were not available** from the capture universe. The breadth conclusions in this brief rest on the RSP-versus-SPY spread, the NYSE Composite, the Russell and the sector table, which are consistent with each other but are a proxy for a proper breadth read.

TIMING & UNVERIFIED

- **Capture window: 06:03:25-06:03:27 GMT+8 on Tuesday 22 September 2026 — 2.7 seconds, well inside the ten-minute standard.** No top-up pass was required and no row in this document carries a second capture time.
- **Age of the stalest rows: 2 hours 3 minutes.** That is every US cash equity close, settled at 16:00 ET. Treasury yields and sector ETFs share that age. Futures, energy and metals futures settles are between 1 and 2 hours old. Asian index closes quoted in section 12 are roughly **20 hours** old and marked as previous closes throughout.
- **Roughly three minutes of the new Globex session are captured, and three minutes is not information.** Nothing in this brief characterises the overnight tape as having moved, because at capture it had not yet had the opportunity. A reader wanting an overnight verdict should look again after the Asian open.
- **The risk ranges in section 4 will be superseded in approximately 13 hours,** when tonight's Early Look publishes at roughly 19:25 GMT+8. The bands quoted here were published before Monday's session and have not yet been redrawn around a tape that closed above two of their ceilings and below two of their floors. Expect movement, particularly in SPX, COMPQ, WTIC and XLE.
- **Bitcoin and Ether are the only figures in this document that were live and meaningful at capture,** and both are in markets that trade continuously. At a 6.77% daily amplitude, the Bitcoin level quoted may be materially stale within an hour of this brief being read.
- **Nothing here is verified against a broker or exchange feed.** Prices come from a single commercial vendor, reconciled by hand against wire copy on the headline rows only. **Verify live prices before acting on anything in this document.**